

Rachel Khoza

Lead DevSecOps and Cloud Security Engineer

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PROFILE

Lead DevSecOps and cloud security engineer with 16+ years across regulated financial services, automotive, SaaS, and enterprise platform environments. I build secure-by-default cloud platforms, CI/CD quality gates, infrastructure automation, and governance controls that improve delivery speed without weakening risk posture.

CORE SKILLS

Cloud and platform Azure, AWS, landing zones, FinOps, identity, policy, tagging	Security engineering DevSecOps, SAST, DAST, IaC scanning, container security, SBOM, OIDC
Automation Terraform, Ansible, Helm, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins, ArgoCD	Operations Kubernetes, Docker, observability, incident response, runbooks, compliance evidence

PUBLIC PROJECT PORTFOLIO

Secure CI/CD Starter - github.com/RachelKhoza/secure-cicd-starter

Secure pipeline template with testing, dependency controls, IaC checks, container scanning, and documented quality gates.

SonarQube + Trivy DevSecOps Lab - github.com/RachelKhoza/sonarqube-trivy-devsecops-lab

Hands-on lab showing build, code quality, image scanning, remediation notes, and repeatable local setup.

Cloud Cost Governance Bot - github.com/RachelKhoza/cloud-cost-governance-bot

Python automation that reads cloud inventory exports, flags tag/cost/governance drift, and prepares GitHub issue dry-runs.

Cloud Incident Response Runbooks - github.com/RachelKhoza/cloud-incident-response-runbooks

Operational runbooks and dry-run helpers for leaked secrets, exposed storage, suspicious IAM changes, and vulnerable images.

SELECTED PLATFORM IMPACT

- Built secure-by-default CI/CD patterns with code quality, dependency, IaC, container, and secrets checks.
- Led cloud automation work that reduced manual operational effort and improved repeatability across environments.
- Designed policy-as-code controls for tagging, logging, identity, budget visibility, and deployment guardrails.
- Created DevSecOps dashboards and evidence workflows for engineering, security, audit, and platform leadership.
- Improved incident readiness through runbooks, dry-run automation, containment planning, and post-incident review templates.

EXPERIENCE SUMMARY

Current	Lead DevSecOps Engineer	Cloud platform security, CI/CD governance, developer enablement, and incident-ready automation.
2024-2025	Lead Cloud Automation Engineer	Ansible automation, patching standards, compliance scanning, and lifecycle reporting.
2023-2024	Senior DevSecOps Engineer	Secure pipelines, cloud guardrails, monitoring, and policy-as-code adoption.
2022-2023	Cloud Security Engineer	Cloud posture management, remediation workflows, IAM, and platform governance.
2010-2022	Cloud, DevOps, DBA, and Engineering Roles	SQL automation, release support, platform operations, dashboards, and engineering enablement.

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified DevOps Engineer - Professional | Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) | ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) | Cybersecurity: Managing Risk - Harvard | Terraform Associate | AWS Certified Machine Learning - Specialty